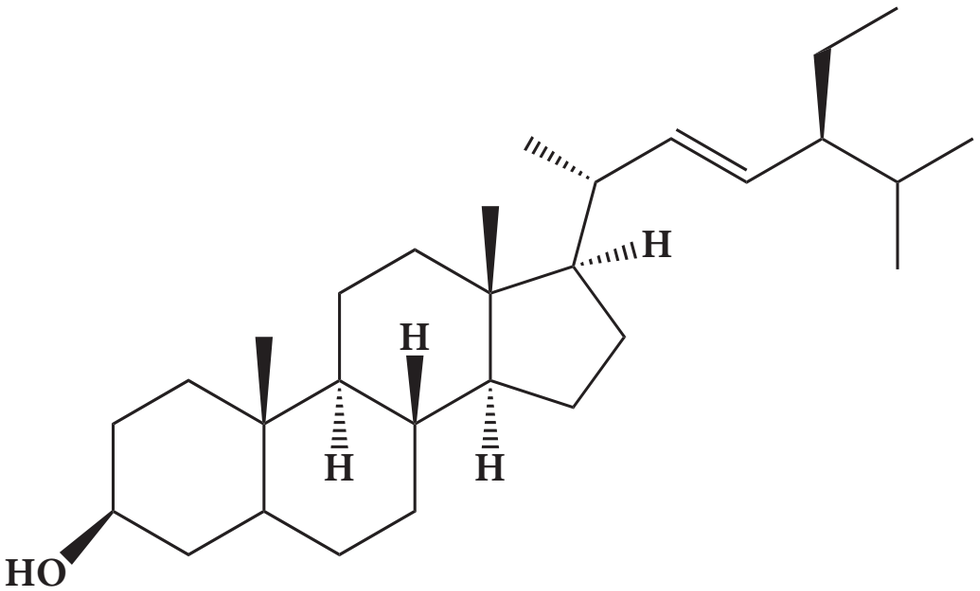
- Fungi are also grown industrially for extraction of ergosterol and synthesis of Vitamin D.

iv. Stigmasterol

Stigmasterol also known as Wulzen anti-stiffness factor, is a plant sterol. Stigmasterol is an unsaturated phytosterol occurring in a number of medicinal herbs. Stigmasterol is also found in various vegetables, legumes, nuts, seeds, and unpasteurized milk.



Stigmasterol

Figure 6.19 Structure of Stigamasterol

Applications:

- Stigmasterol is used as a precursor in the manufacture of semisynthetic progesterone, a valuable human hormone that plays an important physiological role in the regulatory and tissue rebuilding mechanisms.

- Acts as an intermediate in the biosynthesis of androgens, estrogens, and corticoids.

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